

Patria Station Cafe

Authentic Argentine food and coffee

“Best Argentinian Restaurant in Berkeley Heights”

Preliminary Research:

Who is the client and what do they want?

- Patria Station Cafe - serves authentic Argentine food and coffee
- Located in Berkeley Heights, NJ
- “Every dish is made with fresh ingredients and time-honored recipes; every meal feels like home.”
- Values: Passion and Tradition
- Hours:
 - Monday: Closed
 - Tuesday - Thursday: 8 AM – 6 PM
 - Friday - 8 AM – 8 PM
 - Saturday 10 AM – 8 PM
 - Sunday: 10 AM – 3 PM

Interview Questions:

Genesis

1. Please describe your past experiences in this endeavor.
2. Who is your target, and what problem or demand are you addressing, and what solution will you provide?
3. What is your USP (Unique Selling Proposition)?
4. Who are your competitors?
5. How would you measure and define success? (using benchmarks and metrics)

Zeenat

6. Immediate and long-term goals? Verbal objectives and Key Performance Indicators (KPI) as you see fit.
7. Where do you see yourself and your business in 10-15 years?
8. What keeps you from achieving your vision, metrics, goals, and success? Internal and external constraints.
9. What can help you achieve success? Advantages and opportunities.
10. What are your guidelines and priorities? What are you doing or planning to do to overcome these constraints and exploit these opportunities?

Ellie:

11. What media and channels do you use (or want us to use) to reach your target audience? And how?
12. How often does the website get updated, and do you have someone specifically who works on it?
13. What would you like our team to accomplish through this project?
14. Are there any specific areas, challenges, or opportunities you would like us to focus on?
15. What type of content do your customers respond to most, and what do you want your social media posts to accomplish?

Due Diligence:

Ellie Kilgallen:

Possible Competitors:

- Other restaurants, cafes, and other food services in Berkley Heights, NJ
- <https://www-referenceusa-com.proxy.libraries.rutgers.edu/UsBusiness/Search/Custom/a40d9f3ca0c0418ca40c7a827691c018>

Company Name	Parent Company Name	Executive First Name	Executive Last Name	Address	City	State	ZIP Code
Bubbakoo's Burritos	BUBBAKOO'S FRANCHISE SYSTS LLC			410 Springfield Ave	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Cafe Vincotto				579 Springfield Ave	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Charkoal Portuguese Grill				161 Sherman Ave	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Clemente's Pizzeria-Cafe Itin				430 Springfield Ave # D	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Cousins Deli		Katie	Urban	417 Springfield Ave	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Delicious Heights		Ralph	Aquaviva	428 Springfield Ave # A	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Domino's	DOMINO'S PIZZA INC	Nehal M	Patel	629 Springfield Ave	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
East Japanese Restaurant		Peter	Huang	408 Springfield Ave # 1	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Goodmans Deli & Restaurant		Don	Parkins	400 Springfield Ave # 1	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Grain & Cane		Rocco	Petriello	250 Connell Dr	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Hop Hing Chinese				430 Springfield Ave # B	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Neelam Indian Cuisine		Jitu	Mehta	295 Springfield Ave	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Proud Thai Cookery		Perapong	Uttarapong	645 Springfield Ave	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Round Table Studios LLC		Stephen	Kilroy	200 Connell Dr	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Runnells Operating		Zack	Rosenberg	40 Watchung Way	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Sub Zone		Lawrence	Arizona	559 Springfield Ave # 1	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922
Toss Em Wing Factory		Jalpesh	Chokshi	410 Springfield Ave	Berkeley Heights	NJ	7922

Social Media Marketing for Smaller Businesses:

<https://research-ebsco-com.proxy.libraries.rutgers.edu/c/nx7rpm/search/details/lznt376gfb?ctx=1VsXvtzSAbVPAVhqUFmyI&db=buh&limiters=FT%3AY&pos=1&q=social%20media%20marketing%20for%20small%20businesses&searchMode=all>

- Small business owner's best bet is to choose a single social network
 - Don't want to spread yourself too thin or overwhelm yourself/team members
- Pick the platform most appropriate for the business
- Growth from social media takes time (set realistic goals)
- “80% of the content you distribute via social should be about your customers,” he says. What they're interested in, what their needs are, and new solutions to their problems. "Only 20% should be about you and your business."

Genesis Agüero:

1. Social Media Influence on Food and Foodservice

<https://clients.mintel.com/content/report/social-media-influence-on-food-and-foodservice-us-2025?fromSearch=%3Ffreetext%3Dsocial%2Bmedia%2Brestaurants%26resultPosition%3D35>

a. What article focuses on

- i. Mintel reported in May 2025 on how US consumers use social media to find food, restaurants, and deals, based on a survey of 2,000 adults.
- ii. Nearly 90% of consumers use social media daily, and Facebook, TikTok, YouTube, and Instagram are where they look for food content.
- iii. Diners most want deals and discounts (55%) from restaurants, followed by product information and news updates.
- iv. Mintel sorts consumers into 4 groups, from very active “Digital Foodies” to skeptical “Discerning Diners” who trust reviews over ads.

b. Connects to Patria Station

- i. Supports picking 1 platform and doing it well
- ii. Shows what to post and who responds to what
- iii. Backs bilingual content, cultural storytelling, and events

1. U.S. Census Bureau. Berkeley Heights Township, Union County, NJ

[https://data.census.gov/profile/Berkeley Heights township, Union County, New Jersey?g=060XX00US3403905320#populations-and-people](https://data.census.gov/profile/Berkeley%20Heights%20township,%20Union%20County,%20New%20Jersey?g=060XX00US3403905320#populations-and-people)

a. What article focuses on

- i. Wealthy, educated neighborhood
 1. Around \$204,658 per household, and most pursued a college education. Which shows that they can afford to eat out and may care about real, traditional food.
- ii. Older Crowd
 1. Average age is 46, which means that the cafe should use Facebook and Instagram, plus additional use of flyers
- iii. Not many Spanish Speakers

1. Only about 1,140 Hispanic or Latino people live in town, and about 2.9% speak Spanish at home.
 2. Cafe should cater to everyone, not only Latino customers
- b. Connects to Patria Station
- i. Fits the brand - cafe's values are tradition and "feels like home"
 1. Educated, higher-income communities are likely to appreciate authentic food and its story behind it.
 - ii. Shapes where to promote
 1. An older local crowd points to Facebook, Instagram, and in-person marketing, not only TikTok
 - iii. Shows the cafe's opportunity
 1. With few Spanish speakers nearby, Patria Station can introduce Argentine food to a mostly new audience, so its marketing should explain the food also without assuming people know it.

Zeenat Sayed

1. Social Media Marketing and Restaurants' Brand Equity After COVID-19: A Revitalizing Model

Source: *Journal of Vacation Marketing*

Authors: Ghaith Al-Abdallah, Mariwan Ismael, and Latifa Attieh

<https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/13567667241277207>

What article focuses on

1. The study looks at how social media marketing affects restaurant brand equity, meaning things like brand awareness, perceived quality, loyalty, and the associations customers have with a restaurant.

2. Researchers surveyed 618 active social media users who followed local restaurant accounts and looked at four main parts of restaurant social media: interaction, trendiness, customization, and entertainment.
3. Interaction had the strongest effect on brand equity, followed by trendiness and customization. Surprisingly, entertainment by itself did not have a significant effect.
4. The study also found that online word-of-mouth matters, including ratings, reviews, posts, and opinions from other customers. Ratings had the strongest effect out of these.

Connects to Patria Station Cafe

1. Patria already seems to have strong interaction on its social media, so this study can help us understand why its current strategy may be working rather than assuming it needs to completely change.
2. The study found that interaction had the strongest effect on restaurant brand equity, followed by trendiness and customization. This connects well to Patria because its Instagram is not just pictures of food. A lot of its content connects the restaurant to Argentine culture, its customers, local events, and things happening in the community.
3. Patria's World Cup-related content is a really good example of the trendiness part of the study. The cafe has become connected to the local World Cup excitement, and its Instagram posts about “Leo Messi Way” were even picked up and embedded by outside news outlets.
4. The research also found that ratings, reviews, posts, and customer opinions strengthen the relationship between social media marketing and restaurant brand equity. That means Patria could build on the interaction it already has by finding more ways to turn engaged followers into people who post, review, share, and talk about their experiences.
5. Main takeaway: Patria may not need to completely rethink its social media. The bigger opportunity could be figuring out what is already creating so much interaction and how they can build on it more consistently.

2. Linking Social Media Marketing to Restaurant Performance – The Moderating Role of Advertising Expenditure

Source: Han, W., Ozdemir, O., & Agarwal, S. (2024), Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Insights, 7(4), 1852–1870.

<https://www-proquest-com.proxy.libraries.rutgers.edu/docview/3089808147?accountid=13626&pq-origsite=primo&sourcetype=Scholarly%20Journals>

1. What the article focuses on

1. The study looks at how social media marketing is connected to restaurant sales and whether advertising budgets make a difference. Researchers analyzed 12 years of Facebook data from 39 publicly traded U.S. restaurant companies, looking at their posts, likes, shares, comments, advertising spending and annual revenue.
2. The researchers found that restaurants with more posts, likes, shares and positive comments tended to have higher sales revenue. However, the total number of comments alone did not have a statistically significant relationship with revenue.
3. One of the more interesting findings was that social media engagement had a stronger relationship with sales for restaurants with smaller advertising budgets. This suggests that social media could be particularly valuable for restaurants that cannot spend as much on traditional advertising.

2. Connects to Patria Station Cafe

1. Patria already appears to have a lot of interaction on Instagram, so I think the bigger question is how much of that engagement is actually translating into customers visiting the restaurant and making purchases.
2. This research gives us a reason to look beyond Patria's follower count and overall engagement. We could analyze which posts receive the most shares and positive comments, especially its food, Argentine culture and community related content, to better understand what its audience responds to.
3. Since Patria is an independent cafe, it would also be useful to find out how much it currently spends on advertising. If its budget is relatively small, the study suggests there may be an opportunity to build on the engagement it already has without relying entirely on paid advertising.

4. We could also ask Carolina whether she has noticed increases in customers or sales following particularly successful posts or events. This would help us understand whether Patria's online popularity is translating into actual business results.

LINKS

PDF TO MORE INFO:

<https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/?tab=rm&ogbl#search/zie/FMfcgzQhWTsMVZzcnbtrGNSIWLqBqzsq>

WEBSITE:

<https://patriastationcafe.com/>

MEETING TIMES:

<https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1KAeiEdS3ZL7HLI48xbBUhC3kt-bDAITfGCY2zXe3vJw/edit?gid=1761952332#gid=1761952332>

DATABASE

<https://libguides.rutgers.edu/marketing>

RESEARCHING VIDEO

https://rutgers.instructure.com/courses/426366/files/60594954?module_item_id=14948172

THEIR PLATFORMS:

[instagram](#)

[tiktok](#)

[facebook](#)